# A Unified Digital Payment Ecosystem for Asian Economic Integration

**White Paper v1.0 — Conceptual and Economic Framework**

October 2026

**One Asia. One Network. A Connected Economy.**

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## Executive Summary

Asia represents one of the world's most important economic regions. Its economies are connected through international trade, manufacturing, investment, tourism, education, and digital commerce.

Yet the movement of money between Asian countries remains fragmented.

Businesses face different banking systems, currencies, settlement procedures, payment providers, and regulatory requirements. Individuals sending money across borders may encounter additional costs and complicated conversion processes.

One Asia Coin proposes a common digital payment infrastructure designed to connect participating Asian economies.

The project combines three essential components:

1. **One Asia Coin (OAC):** A proposed common digital payment and settlement asset.
2. **One Asia Network:** An interoperable infrastructure connecting participating payment providers and financial institutions.
3. **One Asia Wallet:** A proposed application through which users and merchants can send, receive, and manage payments.

The initial economic model proposes evaluating a reserve-backed digital payment asset, with issuance and redemption governed by transparent rules.

The network would support local-currency conversion, cross-border settlement, merchant payments, and business transactions.

One Asia Coin would not replace national currencies or central banks. Instead, it would seek to provide an additional payment mechanism connecting existing financial systems.

The project would initially focus on selected payment corridors before considering broader regional expansion.

Its long-term vision is to make payments between participating Asian economies as accessible and convenient as domestic digital payments.

**Important status:** One Asia Coin is a proposed concept. No issuer, reserve, blockchain, payment partnership, regulatory authorization, or operational network is established by this document.

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# 1.1 The Vision

One Asia Coin envisions a future in which Asian economies can exchange value through a common digital payment ecosystem.

A business in Uzbekistan should be able to pay a supplier in South Korea.

A tourist from Kazakhstan should be able to make a payment in Malaysia.

A merchant in Vietnam should be able to receive payment from a customer in Japan.

These transactions should be understandable, transparent, and accessible without requiring every participant to maintain a complicated collection of international payment arrangements.

The project proposes a shared payment framework connecting participating economies through common technical standards and settlement infrastructure.

# 1.2 Mission

The mission of One Asia Coin is to facilitate economic integration across Asia by developing an interoperable digital payment ecosystem.

The project aims to:

- Simplify cross-border payments.
- Improve payment accessibility.
- Reduce unnecessary transaction costs.
- Support international trade.
- Facilitate merchant payments.
- Improve payment transparency.
- Support local-currency conversion.
- Connect existing financial infrastructure.
- Encourage regional economic cooperation.

# 1.3 Core Principles

One Asia Coin would be developed around the following principles.

**Interoperability**

The network should connect existing payment systems instead of requiring every country to adopt an entirely new financial infrastructure.

**Monetary sovereignty**

Participating countries should retain their national currencies and monetary policies.

**Transparency**

Issuance, reserve management, transaction fees, and governance should follow clearly defined rules.

**Security**

The network should undergo independent technical and operational security assessments.

**Accessibility**

The payment experience should be simple enough for ordinary users and practical for businesses.

**Financial responsibility**

The project should prioritize actual payment utility rather than speculative demand.

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# 2.1 Fragmented Cross-Border Payments

International payments may involve multiple financial institutions, currency conversion processes, and settlement arrangements.

These arrangements can introduce:

- Additional fees.
- Settlement delays.
- Foreign exchange costs.
- Liquidity requirements.
- Operational complexity.
- Limited payment availability.

The Bank for International Settlements has explored these challenges through projects involving cross-border payment infrastructure.

Project mBridge, for example, investigated a shared distributed-ledger platform connecting participating central banks and commercial banks for cross-border payments and settlement. [1]

One Asia Coin draws inspiration from the broader principle of shared payment infrastructure while proposing a distinct regional payment ecosystem.

# 2.2 Currency Fragmentation

Asian economies operate with different national currencies.

A payment between two countries may require conversion through one or more intermediary currencies.

The economic challenge is not simply the existence of different currencies. It is the cost and complexity of connecting them.

One Asia Coin proposes a common payment layer that could connect local currencies through participating liquidity providers.

## 2.3 Financial Connectivity

Existing regional initiatives demonstrate that payment connectivity is an important economic objective.

ASEAN has encouraged regional payment connectivity, interoperability, and the promotion of local-currency transactions. [2]

One Asia Coin would seek to complement these developments through a technology platform connecting participating payment providers and institutions.

The project would not assume that all Asian countries would adopt the same monetary system.

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The proposed ecosystem consists of four components.

## 3.1 One Asia Coin (OAC)

OAC is the proposed digital payment asset.

Its intended purpose is to facilitate transfers and settlement within the One Asia ecosystem.

Potential use cases include:

- Person-to-person transfers.
- Merchant payments.
- Business-to-business transactions.
- Cross-border settlement.
- Digital commerce.
- International remittances.

The final monetary design would determine whether OAC is primarily a retail payment asset, a settlement instrument, or both.

## 3.2 One Asia Network

The One Asia Network would provide the infrastructure for recording and verifying transactions.

Its proposed functions include:

- Transaction processing.
- Asset transfers.
- Payment routing.
- Settlement coordination.
- Currency conversion integration.
- Merchant payment processing.
- Financial institution connectivity.

The project would evaluate existing distributed-ledger technologies before considering a dedicated blockchain.

Developing a new blockchain would only be justified if existing infrastructure could not satisfy the project's technical and economic requirements.

## 3.3 One Asia Wallet

The One Asia Wallet would provide an accessible interface for sending and receiving payments.

Proposed features include:

- Digital balances.
- QR-code payments.
- Payment requests.
- Merchant transactions.
- Transaction history.
- Currency conversion quotations.
- Payment confirmations.
- Supported local-currency deposits and withdrawals.

The wallet should display the actual amount being sent, the fees, the exchange rate, and the amount expected to be received.

## 3.4 One Asia Payment Gateway

The payment gateway would connect the network to external financial systems.

Potential integrations include:

- Licensed banks.
- Payment institutions.
- Merchant acquiring providers.
- Electronic money institutions.
- Foreign exchange providers.
- Regulated digital asset service providers.

The gateway would support the integration of local payment systems without requiring each participating country to use the same banking infrastructure.

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The monetary model is one of the most important parts of the One Asia Coin project.

A digital asset intended for payments must provide a clear answer to the following questions:

- What determines its value?
- Who issues it?
- How is new supply created?
- How can users redeem it?
- What happens if the issuer fails?
- What protects users against excessive price volatility?

The proposed framework is designed around a reserve-backed payment asset, subject to legal and economic feasibility.

# 4.1 Proposed Reference Value

One Asia Coin would evaluate a reference unit linked to a basket of participating Asian currencies.

A possible reference basket could include currencies such as:

- Chinese yuan.
- Japanese yen.
- South Korean won.
- Indian rupee.
- Indonesian rupiah.
- Malaysian ringgit.
- Thai baht.
- Uzbekistani som.
- Kazakhstani tenge.

The final composition would depend on legal feasibility, market liquidity, economic relevance, and the availability of reliable foreign exchange markets.

A basket-based reference could provide a regional identity while reducing dependence on a single national currency.

However, a currency basket does not automatically guarantee price stability.

The project would need to define:

- The basket composition.
- Currency weights.
- Rebalancing methodology.
- Valuation sources.
- Reserve assets.
- Redemption rights.
- Liquidity arrangements.

The basket would be a proposed reference unit, not a claim that OAC already has a fixed value.

## 4.2 Reserve-Backed Issuance

Under the proposed reserve-backed model, new OAC would only be issued when eligible reserve assets have been received and verified according to the issuance rules.

The issuer would be required to maintain sufficient eligible assets to meet its outstanding redemption obligations.

A simplified issuance process would be:

1. An authorized participant submits a request to acquire OAC.
2. The participant transfers eligible funds.
3. The issuer confirms receipt of the funds.
4. The issuance system creates the corresponding OAC.
5. OAC is transferred to the participant.
6. The issuance is recorded and reported.

The reverse process would apply to redemption.

This framework would require a legally responsible issuer and a clearly defined redemption mechanism.

## 4.3 Reserve Management

Reserve assets would be held separately from the operating funds of the project.

The reserve policy would define:

- Eligible assets.
- Custodian requirements.
- Liquidity requirements.
- Counterparty limits.
- Valuation methodology.
- Redemption procedures.
- Independent assurance.
- Public reporting.

The project would evaluate highly liquid, low-risk reserve assets consistent with the applicable legal framework.

Reserve assets would not be used for speculative trading, lending, or unrelated operating expenses unless explicitly permitted by the governing legal framework and fully disclosed.

## 4.4 Minting and Burning

OAC issuance and redemption would be governed by transparent procedures.

**Minting**

New OAC would be created only after the corresponding eligible reserve assets have been received and verified.

**Burning**

OAC submitted for redemption would be removed from circulation after the redemption process has been completed according to the applicable rules.

**Supply reporting**

The project would publish information about:

- Total issued supply.
- Total redeemed supply.
- Outstanding circulation.
- Reserve assets.
- Relevant reconciliation reports.

The system would not use an arbitrary fixed supply simply for marketing purposes.

For a reserve-backed payment asset, supply should respond to legitimate payment demand and redemption.

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# 5.1 Cross-Border Payment Flow

Consider a payment between Uzbekistan and South Korea.

A customer in Uzbekistan wants to send money to a recipient in South Korea.

The proposed process is:

**Step 1 — Payment initiation**

The sender enters the recipient's details and payment amount.

**Step 2 — Local currency funding**

The sender funds the payment using a supported local payment method.

**Step 3 — Currency conversion**

A participating financial institution converts the relevant amount according to the applicable exchange-rate quotation.

**Step 4 — Settlement**

The transaction is processed through the One Asia payment infrastructure.

**Step 5 — Recipient payment**

The receiving institution converts or redeems the payment value according to the supported arrangement.

**Step 6 — Confirmation**

Both participants receive a transaction confirmation.

The recipient could receive the payment in OAC or in Korean won, depending on the supported service.

The transaction would depend on available liquidity, local regulations, and participating financial institutions.

## 5.2 Foreign Exchange Routing

The network would seek to identify an efficient conversion route.

Possible routes could include:

- Direct local-currency conversion.
- Conversion through a regional liquidity provider.
- Conversion through the reference basket.
- Conversion through a regulated settlement asset.

The routing system would evaluate:

- Exchange rates.
- Transaction fees.
- Available liquidity.
- Settlement requirements.
- Payment restrictions.

The system would display the available quotation before the user confirms the payment.

## 5.3 Atomic Settlement

The technical design would evaluate atomic settlement where supported by the selected infrastructure.

Atomic settlement means that the relevant transaction completes fully or does not complete at all.

This can help reduce settlement risk in transactions involving multiple assets.

However, atomic settlement on a blockchain does not automatically guarantee successful fiat payment through external banks.

The project would therefore distinguish blockchain settlement from the completion of the recipient's local bank payment.

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## 6.1 Distributed Ledger Technology

One Asia Coin would evaluate distributed-ledger infrastructure capable of supporting reliable payment processing.

The technical requirements would include:

- Transaction integrity.
- Security.
- Reliable settlement.
- Scalability.
- Interoperability.
- Operational resilience.
- Transparent transaction records.

The project would evaluate existing infrastructure such as Stellar and XRP Ledger as technical references.

Stellar's anchor infrastructure demonstrates how digital payment networks can connect with traditional financial rails. XRP Ledger provides examples of cross-currency payment routing and atomic payment execution. [3][4]

These systems would be evaluated as technical references, not assumed to be the final infrastructure for One Asia Coin.

## 6.2 Consensus Mechanism

The network would evaluate energy-efficient consensus mechanisms.

Potential models include:

- Byzantine Fault Tolerant consensus.
- Federated consensus.
- Permissioned validator infrastructure.
- Hybrid public and institutional models.

The final choice would depend on the requirements for security, decentralization, performance, and governance.

The project would not introduce a new consensus algorithm without a demonstrated technical need.

## 6.3 Validator Structure

If a dedicated network is developed, validators could be operated by qualified institutional participants.

Potential participants could include:

- Independent infrastructure providers.
- Approved financial institutions.
- Technical organizations.
- Ecosystem infrastructure partners.

The validator framework would define:

- Admission requirements.
- Operational responsibilities.
- Security standards.
- Monitoring requirements.
- Removal procedures.
- Governance rights.

The project would seek to avoid excessive concentration of validator control.

## 6.4 Interoperability

The One Asia Network would require a common integration framework.

The framework could include:

- Standardized payment APIs.
- Payment messaging.
- Digital asset interfaces.
- Local payment system integrations.
- Identity and compliance interfaces.
- Settlement reporting.

The objective would be to connect different systems through a common technical layer.

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## 7.1 International Trade

One Asia Coin could support international business transactions.

Potential applications include:

- Import payments.
- Export payments.
- Supplier settlement.
- Business invoices.
- Wholesale payments.
- Corporate treasury operations.

Businesses could use participating payment providers to transfer payment value across supported markets.

## 7.2 Merchant Payments

The proposed network could enable merchants to accept digital payments from participating wallets.

The merchant could receive OAC or the supported local currency.

A payment gateway would provide the merchant with the transaction confirmation and settlement information.

## 7.3 Remittances

One Asia Coin could support transfers between individuals.

The payment system would display the transaction amount, exchange rate, fees, and expected recipient amount.

The project would seek to provide transparent pricing and reliable settlement.

## 7.4 Tourism

The wallet could support payments for:

- Hotels.
- Restaurants.
- Transportation.
- Retail purchases.
- Tourism services.

The project would aim to provide a familiar digital payment experience for travelers.

## 7.5 Digital Commerce

One Asia Coin could be integrated into participating e-commerce platforms.

The payment gateway could provide:

- Payment authorization.
- Settlement confirmation.
- Refund support.
- Transaction reporting.
- Merchant integration.

The technical framework would need to account for consumer protection and applicable payment regulations.

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The tokenomics model must support the actual economic purpose of One Asia Coin.

The proposed framework does not assume that a cryptocurrency must have a fixed maximum supply or that its market price should increase.

## 8.1 Token Utility

OAC would be designed to support:

- Digital payments.
- Settlement.
- Merchant transactions.
- Transfers.
- Payment network integration.

Any additional utility would require a clear economic justification.

## 8.2 Supply Model

Under the proposed reserve-backed model, OAC supply would be determined by issuance and redemption.

There would be no arbitrary token allocation for speculative purposes.

The project would publish a transparent issuance methodology.

## 8.3 Transaction Fees

The network would evaluate a transparent fee structure.

Potential fee categories include:

- Network processing fees.
- Payment provider fees.
- Foreign exchange costs.
- Merchant service fees.
- Redemption fees, where applicable.

The fee structure would distinguish network fees from fees charged by financial institutions.

The project would not promise zero fees unless the economics of the payment system could support such a model.

## 8.4 Revenue Model

Potential revenue sources could include:

- Payment processing fees.
- Merchant integration services.
- Institutional connectivity.

- Enterprise software services.
- Foreign exchange service margins, where legally permitted.
- Payment infrastructure licensing.

The project would evaluate each revenue source for legal feasibility and economic sustainability.

Revenue would not depend on guaranteeing token price appreciation.

## 8.5 No Guaranteed Returns

OAC would be designed as a payment instrument.

This white paper does not promise:

- Investment returns.
- Token price appreciation.
- Guaranteed profits.
- Guaranteed liquidity.
- Guaranteed adoption.

The project's economic value would depend on its actual utility, financial structure, regulatory compliance, and successful adoption.

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One Asia Coin would require a transparent governance framework.

The proposed structure includes three components.

## 9.1 One Asia Foundation

A legally appropriate foundation or governing organization could oversee the long-term development of the ecosystem.

Potential responsibilities include:

- Protocol development.
- Technical standards.
- Ecosystem coordination.
- Transparency reporting.
- Governance administration.

The legal structure and jurisdiction would be determined through independent legal research.

## 9.2 Institutional Council

A proposed institutional council could coordinate participating financial institutions and ecosystem partners.

Its responsibilities could include:

- Technical interoperability.
- Payment corridor development.
- Operational standards.
- Risk management.
- Institutional participation.

Participation would be voluntary and subject to applicable laws.

## 9.3 Governance Transparency

The project would establish transparent procedures for:

- Protocol changes.
- Validator participation.
- Network upgrades.
- Operational risk management.
- Conflict resolution.
- Public reporting.

The governance model would seek to avoid excessive concentration of control.

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One Asia Coin would require a comprehensive security and compliance framework.

Potential requirements include:

- Customer identification.
- Anti-money laundering controls.
- Sanctions screening.
- Transaction monitoring.
- Fraud prevention.
- Cybersecurity.
- Data protection.
- Wallet security.
- Operational resilience.

The project would evaluate applicable requirements in every jurisdiction where services are offered.

The network would not assume that one country's authorization permits unrestricted operation throughout Asia.

Each payment corridor would require a separate legal and operational assessment.

## 10.1 Security Audits

Before any production deployment, the project would require independent technical assessments.

Potential audit areas include:

- Smart contracts.
- Wallet infrastructure.
- Transaction processing.
- Key management.
- Network infrastructure.
- Reserve controls.
- Issuance and redemption procedures.

Security testing would be repeated after significant changes to the system.

## 10.2 Consumer Protection

The project would evaluate appropriate consumer protection measures.

These could include:

- Transparent payment quotations.
- Clear transaction confirmations.
- Defined dispute procedures.
- Fraud reporting.
- Refund processes.
- Customer support.
- Disclosure of relevant risks.

The applicable protections would depend on the legal framework and the role of participating institutions.

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The following roadmap is a proposed sequence of development stages.

It is not a commitment to launch on specific dates.

# Phase 1 — Research and Feasibility

Objectives:

- Complete the economic feasibility study.
- Define the monetary model.
- Evaluate the reference basket.
- Identify potential payment corridors.
- Evaluate regulatory requirements.
- Define the project governance framework.

# Phase 2 — Technical Prototype

Objectives:

- Develop a testnet.
- Build a basic wallet.
- Implement transaction processing.
- Develop payment APIs.
- Test issuance and redemption simulations.
- Evaluate currency conversion routing.

## Phase 3 — Institutional Preparation

Objectives:

- Identify potential financial partners.
- Evaluate liquidity arrangements.
- Develop compliance procedures.
- Define reserve management requirements.
- Develop merchant integration standards.

## Phase 4 — Controlled Pilot

Objectives:

- Test selected payment corridors.
- Evaluate transaction performance.
- Conduct independent security assessments.
- Measure transaction costs.
- Assess user experience.
- Evaluate operational risks.

## Phase 5 — Regional Expansion

Objectives:

- Expand supported payment corridors.
- Increase merchant participation.
- Improve interoperability.
- Develop additional payment services.
- Evaluate additional markets.

Expansion would depend on regulatory approval, institutional participation, liquidity, and demonstrated operational reliability.

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One Asia Coin recognizes that developing a regional payment ecosystem presents significant challenges.

## Regulatory Risk

Digital asset and payment regulations differ across jurisdictions.

The project would require appropriate legal advice and regulatory assessment before offering services.

## Liquidity Risk

A payment network cannot guarantee efficient currency conversion without sufficient liquidity.

The project would require participating liquidity providers and appropriate risk controls.

## Reserve Risk

A reserve-backed payment asset introduces risks involving custodians, reserve assets, redemption procedures, and issuer solvency.

The reserve framework would require independent assessment and transparent reporting.

## Monetary Risk

A reference basket may experience fluctuations against individual national currencies.

The project would not describe a basket-based payment asset as risk-free or universally stable.

## Cybersecurity Risk

The network would face risks involving unauthorized access, software vulnerabilities, operational failures, and fraud.

Independent security assessments and incident response procedures would be required.

## Adoption Risk

The success of the project would depend on participation from financial institutions, merchants, users, and regulators.

Technical development alone would not guarantee economic adoption.

## Governance Risk

A regional payment ecosystem would require effective governance and coordination.

The project would need clear procedures to manage conflicts, operational changes, and institutional participation.

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The One Asia Coin emblem represents a connected regional economy.

The central number 1 symbolizes a common payment vision.

The globe represents the participating economies.

The orbital ring represents connectivity and the movement of value.

The 50 stars symbolize shared participation, regional cooperation, and the ambition to connect Asian markets.

The stars are a symbolic design element. They do not represent a fixed list of 50 countries, an existing membership structure, or an official regional organization.

The project would remain open to evaluating participation by eligible economies and institutions according to transparent requirements.

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One Asia Coin proposes a common digital payment ecosystem designed to connect participating Asian economies.

Its objective is to make cross-border payments more accessible, transparent, and efficient while preserving the monetary sovereignty of participating countries.

The project recognizes that regional economic integration requires more than a digital asset.

It requires:

- Reliable payment infrastructure.
- Liquidity.
- Security.
- Regulatory compatibility.
- Transparent governance.
- Institutional cooperation.
- Practical economic utility.

One Asia Coin seeks to bring these elements together through a shared digital payment framework.

Its long-term ambition is to support a more connected Asian economy in which individuals and businesses can exchange value across borders with greater simplicity.

**ONE ASIA COIN**

**One Asia. One Network. A Connected Economy.**

[1] Bank for International Settlements. Project mBridge.

https://www.bis.org/project/mbridge

[2] ASEAN. Leaders' Declaration on Advancing Regional Payment Connectivity and Promoting Local Currency Transaction.

https://asean.org/asean-leaders-declaration-on-advancing-regional-payment-connectivity-and-promoting-local-currency-transaction/

[3] Stellar Development Foundation. Stellar Anchor Platform.

https://stellar.org/products-and-tools/anchor-platform

[4] XRP Ledger. Cross-Currency Payments.

https://xrpl.org/docs/concepts/payment-types/cross-currency-payments

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# Disclaimer

This document is a conceptual white paper prepared for research and project development.

It does not constitute an offer to sell digital assets, an investment recommendation, a solicitation for investment, or a guarantee of financial returns.

One Asia Coin is not represented as an operating payment system.

The proposed monetary model, network architecture, tokenomics, governance structure, and roadmap remain subject to further research, technical development, legal review, regulatory assessment, and institutional participation.

No reserve, redemption guarantee, financial institution partnership, or regulatory authorization is established by this document.

Any future implementation would require appropriate professional review and compliance with applicable laws.